TOPIC REPORTS: RESEARCH INSTITUTIONS

GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS

News, Sep – Oct 2026

LITERACY · TRAINING AND SKILLS · RESEARCH INSTITUTIONS

Comoros · Egypt · Ghana · Kenya · Morocco · Sierra Leone · Uganda · Zimbabwe

Comoros

UNIPOD UNIVERSITY INNOVATION SPACE

- **Éducation : L'UDC et le PNUD misent sur l'innovation et l'intelligence artificielle** — La Gazette des Comores, 15 September 2026

  The national university and the United Nations development programme signed a memorandum on training, research and innovation, at its centre a shared innovation space intended to bring students, researchers, entrepreneurs and institutions together on local problems.

Egypt

PEER-REVIEWED ASSESSMENT OF READINESS FOR AI-DRIVEN TRANSFORMATION IN PUBLIC HEALTHCARE

- **Governing AI-driven digital transformation in public healthcare: assessing administrative readiness and institutional capacity in Egypt's health system** — Frontiers in Digital Health, 3 September 2026

  A peer-reviewed study in Frontiers in Digital Health, published on 3 September 2026, assesses whether Egypt's public health institutions are ready for AI-enabled digital transformation. The authors surveyed 387 health administrators and policymakers across 24 governorates and interviewed 18 senior officials and experts; their readiness model explains 68 per cent of the variance in transformation success.

Ghana

UNIVERSITY OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY AT DAMONGO

- **Gov't seeks additional funding for Damongo Science and Technology University** — Ghana News Agency, 2 September 2026

  Ghana's Education Minister Haruna Iddrisu said on 2 September 2026 that a US$30 million Chinese government grant will not be enough to complete and equip the University of Science and Technology at Damongo, which he put at more than US$100 million. The Savannah Region university is planned as a centre for science, robotics, digital sciences and artificial intelligence.

- **Ghana Secures $30 Million Grant for Damongo Tech University** — The Vaultz News, 3 September 2026

  Ghana's education minister Haruna Iddrisu disclosed a US$30 million grant from China's government for a University of Science and Technology at Damongo focused on artificial intelligence and emerging technologies. He made the disclosure during a visit by the new Chinese ambassador, Cong Song. No commitment date or construction timetable is given.

Kenya

RESEARCH ON ALTERNATIVE MEDIA AND ELECTION MISINFORMATION

- **Kenya Alternative Media Report Warns Of Election Misinformation** — KICTANet, 9 September 2026

  The Kenya ICT Action Network launched a report, Many Microphones, Little Accountability, at a webinar on 9 September 2026, finding that Facebook, TikTok, YouTube and X are reshaping political news and spreading misinformation ahead of the 2027 general election. The study drew on three months of platform monitoring, a national survey and interviews.

CIVIL-SOCIETY SUBMISSIONS ON ARTIFICIAL-INTELLIGENCE INSTRUMENTS

- **CIPESA Weighs in on Kenya's Draft Guidance Notes on AI and Emerging Technologies** — CIPESA, 24 September 2026

  CIPESA submitted comments on draft guidance notes on AI and on emerging technologies issued for consultation by Kenya's Office of the Data Protection Commissioner. It warns that requiring adequacy assessments for cross-border transfers could lead to blanket data localisation. It also asks for impact assessments on biometric processing, audits of feed algorithms and oversight of state use.

Morocco

ADAPTVOTE OFFLINE-CAPABLE E-VOTING RESEARCH PROTOTYPE

- **"تجربة مغربية للتصويت الرقمي تجمع التعرف على الوجه و"البلوك تشين** — Hespress, 7 September 2026

  Researchers at Mohammed I University in Oujda and Abdelmalek Essaâdi University in Tétouan tested AdaptVote, an e-voting model combining facial recognition and blockchain, with 300 people in Nador over 12 hours. The network was available for only 35% of the trial; 95.7% passed identity checks first time and voting took 2.1 minutes against 4.5 on paper. It is a research platform, not an official system.

DOMESTIC AI RESEARCH ON CLIMATE ADAPTATION

- **المغرب يوسع أبحاث الذكاء الاصطناعي لمواجهة مخاطر الإجهاد المائي** — Hespress, 10 September 2026

  A scientific review available from 1 September records an expansion of Moroccan research applying artificial intelligence to drought, water scarcity and rising temperatures. It covers forecasting tools, resource monitoring, irrigation, and the management of energy and heat inside cities, across water, agriculture, energy, cities and natural hazards.

Sierra Leone

CIPHER INFORMATION PRIVACY RESEARCH CENTRE

- **CIPHER Launched to Promote Data Protection, Cybersecurity and Digital Privacy** — Truth Media, 9 October 2026

  The Center for Information Privacy, Human-Centered Technology and Ethics Research (CIPHER), an independent research body, launched in Freetown, Sierra Leone, on 6 October 2026. Its chief executive, Cyril Foday-Kallie, said it will research mishandling of personal data, train people on data-subject rights and controllers' duties, and supply evidence for data-protection law and policy.

Uganda

JAPANESE DEVELOPMENT AGENCY RESEARCH COLLABORATION WITH THE NATIONAL UNIVERSITY

- **JICA, Makerere University Explore New Frontiers in AI and Research Collaboration** — Makerere University News, 4 September 2026

  Makerere University and Japan's international cooperation agency explored strengthening academic, research and innovation collaboration between Uganda, Japan and other African countries, with a focus on artificial intelligence, aerospace engineering, materials and remote sensing, food value chains, energy, water and climate change.

Zimbabwe

NATIONAL DIGITAL TECHNOLOGIES POLICY RESEARCH PROGRAMME

- **Call for policy research proposals: National Digital Technologies Policy Research Programme (DTPRP)** — Postal and Telecommunications Regulatory Authority of Zimbabwe, Research Council of Zimbabwe and Scientific and Industrial Research and Development Centre, 7 September 2026

  Zimbabwe's telecommunications regulator, POTRAZ, with the Research Council of Zimbabwe and the Scientific and Industrial Research and Development Centre, invited policy research proposals under a National Digital Technologies Policy Research Programme. Priority areas include AI governance, data governance and sovereignty, platform regulation, connectivity and innovation policy; proposals close on 3 October 2026 and applicants are notified by 23 October.

- **POTRAZ National Digital Technologies Policy Research Programme 2026: Call for Policy Research Proposals** — ApplyNOW (POTRAZ, RCZ and SIRDC call), 9 September 2026

  Zimbabwe's Postal and Telecommunications Regulatory Authority, with the Research Council of Zimbabwe and the Scientific and Industrial Research and Development Centre, called for policy research proposals under a National Digital Technologies Policy Research Programme, closing on 3 October 2026. The five priority areas include AI governance, data governance and cybersecurity, platform regulation and connectivity policy. No funding amount is given.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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